

Too close to work together? Identity conflicts induced by coworker friendships in cyberspace

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ABSTRACT

The meteoric rise in the popularity of social networking sites (SNSs) has connected many employees with their contacts from work. However, clashes are catalyzed when individuals' professional identities collide with their social ones. This paper aims to explore hotel employees' identity conflicts stemming from cross-boundary friendships. Building on cognitive dissonance theory and conservation of resources theory, a multilevel model is proposed to examine how befriending colleagues on SNSs induces unfavorable workplace consequences through the mediation effect of identity conflict. The model further scrutinizes whether task interdependence intensifies this negative spillover. This study probes a novel identity issue aroused by SNS interactions in a professional context and advances research on interpersonal dynamics in organizations. It also provides new insights on the role of team-level situational factors. The results generate managerial implications for hotels and employees, suggesting that both groups should be better prepared for possible dilemmas embedded in cross-boundary relationships.

1. Introduction

Employees spend one third of their time per day in close proximity to their coworkers, and maybe more nowadays, given the rising trend of befriending work colleagues on social networking sites (SNSs) such as Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter. The surging interest in and use of SNSs have blurred the boundaries between personal and professional domains, connecting more than two thirds of employees with colleagues on the Internet (Igloo, 2018). Empirical studies have documented positive spillovers from cyberspace to the workplace, such as more workplace fun, entrenched interpersonal relationships, enhanced coworker support, improved employee identification, increased embeddedness, and higher satisfaction with the job (Yang, 2020a; Yang and Wong, 2020). However, such online friendships may also backfire. Despite concerns about privacy and work-life balance that have been widely discussed in previous literature (e.g., Abril et al., 2012; Bucher et al., 2013; van Zoonen et al., 2016), there exists a potential risk of identity conflict in the workplace—of being “too close to work together” (Yang and Wong, 2020, p. 8). That is, intimacy on SNSs may induce unnecessary trouble in a work context. Such interactions on SNSs may change how individuals view their colleagues. As Del Bosque (2013) noted,

about one half of the employees surveyed agreed that SNSs reshaped their perceptions of the identity of their colleagues, of which 32% of changes were positive and 68% were negative or mixed. Befriending colleagues on SNSs may also generate the “greatest potential for conflict due to mix of social & professional self-presentation” (Archer-Brown et al., 2018, p. 76). Despite its importance, identity conflict across the workplace and SNSs is as yet uncharted territory that has not been empirically scrutinized.

Employees' self-definitions can be multi-faceted. Their intra-unit identity conflicts arise when misalignment exists in values, beliefs, and norms as a result of the collision of their multiple identities, in particular between work and non-work roles (Horton et al., 2014). Such inconsistencies are referred to as “cognitive dissonance” (cognitive dissonance theory: Festinger, 1957). For instance, a female manager often finds her identity as a woman and her identity as a leader incompatible. The former is associated with communal behaviors and feminine traits such as warmth, caring, and cooperation, while the latter is expected to be assertive, competitive, and determined—the archetypal figure of the male (Karelai and Guillén, 2014). With these identity conflicts in the workplace, disamenity may spill over and escalate.

Similar clashes have been catalyzed when individuals' professional

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roles collide with their social ones. As noted by Van Dijck (2013), individuals' self-communication to friends on SNSs is worlds apart from their professional persona. Coworkers' SNS friendships differ from their offline relationships, given the distinctions in the type and depth of information exchange (Huang, 2019). Employees create identities on SNSs through self-representational posts such as personal status, photos, and life events. Their information exchange on SNSs helps to identify the interests and values of the large group to which they belong and creates enjoyment and fun in both cyberspace and the workplace (Archer-Brown et al., 2018; Joinson, 2008). Nevertheless, in many circumstances, this cyberspace friendship has to embrace a mechanism to avoid conflict with colleagues' professional relationships when intimacy causes inconvenience in the workplace. An individual may hesitate to voice disagreement or point out the mistakes of other colleagues for fear of hurting the best friend on Facebook. It is also possible that one may feel offended if others leave the professional etiquette and routine procedures at the door. This provokes concerns regarding close ties with colleagues in cyberspace, which may fail to maintain a professional image and cause a crisis of professionalism (Ollier-Malaterre and Rothbard, 2015; Peluchette et al., 2012, 2013). As Archer-Brown et al. (2018) noted, the mix of self-presentation in life and work domains has induced potential conflicts which can further jeopardize an employee's performance. However, empirical studies to date have not yet examined such negative consequences of coworkers' cyberspace relationships. This calls for research to answer the first research question:

RQ1. Does SNS friendship induce identity conflict in the workplace which in turn influences employees' work performance?

Although boundary crossing between cyberspace and the workplace could induce identity conflicts, such tension may be conditioned by institutional contexts, for example, the task environment as a situational contingency. The task environment is characterized by the level of coordination and collaboration and involves exchanges of information and resources that are essential to the fulfillment of task specifications (Kiggundu, 1983). This notion has been termed "work interdependence." Previous literature on team dynamics has intensively investigated task interdependence as a contingency factor, in most cases as a positive moderator that reinforces the relationship between interpersonal dynamics and work-related outcomes (e.g., Anand et al., 2018; Ceri-Booms et al., 2017; Wong and Berntzen, 2019). However, greater reliance on team members—represented by a higher level of cooperation in the workplace and increased needs for teamwork—will also render greater importance to professional identities. When employees are also connected with their colleagues by SNSs, such a high work interdependence may unexpectedly add to the identity conflict pressure induced by cross-boundary friendships, as a higher magnitude of dissonance arises between the two salient yet conflicting identities. This demands more in-depth research on the moderating role of work interdependence, and thus the second research question is raised:

RQ2. Does work interdependence exacerbate the impact of SNS friendship on identity conflict?

Interpersonal relationships across work and life domains have been extensively researched in the hotel industry, which is service-oriented and labor-intensive and where teamwork and a flat organizational structure are prevalent (Yang and Lau, 2015). This work sets out to address the research questions mentioned previously in such a context. Building on two theories to interpret the impression-management issues—cognitive dissonance theory and conservation of resources theory—a multilevel model is proposed to investigate the extent to which befriending coworkers on SNSs will undermine employees' work performance and job satisfaction through the mediation effect of identity conflict. The model further probes how team-level task interdependence could intensify this tension induced by SNS interactions.

The key contributions of this research are fourfold. First, it is an initial empirical attempt to examine the role of identity conflict in the

SNS–workplace interface. While existing empirical studies on cross-boundary relationships predominantly focus on the positive outcomes, the current research advances the literature by revealing negative spillovers induced by a threat to impression management. Second, it contributes to literature on multiple identities. Context-wise, it responds to calls for more investigations into the configuration of identities with a blend of virtual and real ones. Theory-wise, it provides new evidence of the cognitive dissonance theory in an uncontrived setting and furthers the theoretical understanding in a hybrid arena of cyberspace and the workplace. Third, this study enriches the literature on group-level disparities in cross-boundary relationships. It also advances organizational research that predominantly studies task interdependence as a positive contingency and provides new evidence of potential risks of more conflict in a highly interdependent task environment. Fourth, managerial implications are discussed to help employees and hotels cope with the dilemmas embedded in cross-boundary relationships. Suggestions are provided for hotels to better balance positive and negative spillovers and manage cross-boundary identity problems in different departments.

2. Literature review

2.1. SNS use in the hospitality industry

With "information and communication technologies" (ICTs), "Web 2.0", and "social media" emerging as popular new buzzwords, the use of social media in the tourism and hospitality industry has also become a timely research interest (Nusair, 2020). Two main streams stem from existing literature, focusing on social media use related to external stakeholders (e.g., tourists and hotel guests) and internal stakeholders (e.g., hotel employees and working groups), respectively. The first stream of research dominates the literature, mainly investigating social media in destination and hotel marketing (Leung et al., 2019). A plethora of research has investigated how this mega-trend provides new channels for promotion and communication, reshapes attitudes towards a destination/hotel and subsequent decisions, and leverages customer co-created values (see (Leung et al., 2013) and (Leung et al., 2019) for reviews of relevant studies).

The second school of research on social media in the workplace is outpaced by organizational practice in the hotel industry (King and Lee, 2016; Ladkin and Buhalis, 2016). Previous studies have discussed social media as a tool for recruitment (Gibbs et al., 2015; Ladkin and Buhalis, 2016; Madera, 2012), a platform to express work-related feelings (Melián-González and Bulchand-Gidumal, 2017; Stamolampros et al., 2019), a vehicle for knowledge management (Bhatti et al., 2020; Sigala and Chalkiti, 2015), and an at-work break activity to aid employee well-being (Cheng and Cho, 2021). These studies predominantly concentrate on work-related use of social media platforms, while dynamics in the non-work domains are rarely examined. In particular, SNSs as a special form of social media are a platform that connects employees' life and work domains, which catalyzes a series of issues when employees cross the work–life boundaries by befriending their work colleagues.

While research on boundary crossing between the workplace and SNSs has been steadily on the rise in the management and information science literature, only recently has it commanded research attention in the hospitality context. Yang (2020a) has explored why hotel employees engage in SNS interactions with their colleagues (and why they do not) and has concluded that the motivational factors of coworker interactions include relationship reinforcement, career advancement, and peer influence. In addition, such interactions benefit workplace relationships on the whole, although both fun and stress are evoked in the workplace. (Yang and Wong, 2020) have provided empirical evidence that SNS friendships with coworkers enable employees to acquire more instrumental support at work, which enhances their job embeddedness and satisfaction. From a different perspective, Yang (2020b) has discussed supervisor–subordinate friendships on SNSs, concluding that shifting

boundaries with supervisors help reinforce leader–member exchange, which also benefits the organizations by promoting organizational citizenship behaviors. While these studies are insightful, research on boundary crossing and employee exchanges on SNSs remains sporadic and limited.

2.2. Boundary crossing and coworker exchanges on SNSs

A boundary perspective has been widely employed to understand different work and life domains and how employees demarcate and transition between these domains (Allen et al., 2014; Desrochers and Sargent, 2004). In a work–life context, boundaries embody the socially constructed lines that segment professional and personal domains and imply the scope of different roles in these domains (Ashforth et al., 2000). Why and how individuals maintain or transition across the boundaries is largely determined by the physical and psychological costs of boundary crossing (Bulger et al., 2007).

The rise of SNSs has profoundly changed the ways in which employees interact with each other, blurring the work–life boundaries and bridging domains which were once well defined (Ollier-Malaterre et al., 2019). Technology affords employees improved connectivity with their colleagues both at and after work and encourages them to communicate between different roles with more flexible and permeable boundaries. Flexibility refers to the malleability that makes the relaxation of boundaries possible so as to meet the demands of other domains, for example, leaving the office at any time for personal reasons; it thus represents the physical dimension of a boundary, both special and temporal. By contrast, permeability conveys the psychological dimension that allows an employee to enact other roles while physically located in a certain domain (Bulger et al., 2007). The pervasiveness of coworker SNS communication makes work–life boundaries more porous and reinforces both flexibility and permeability. This further catalyzes higher role integration and allows a wider variety of exchanges among coworkers (Ollier-Malaterre et al., 2013; Peluchette et al., 2012; Schmidt et al., 2016).

Previous literature implies that hotel employees engage in SNS exchanges with their colleagues for different reasons (Yang, 2020a). The main drivers that propel cyberspace friendships include SNS-facilitated work-related communication (Charoensukmongkol, 2014; Del Bosque, 2013; Huang and Liu, 2017), relationship reinforcement (Ali-Hassan et al., 2015; Peluchette et al., 2013), opportunities for career advancement (Yang, 2020b), and influences from other colleagues (Frampton and Child, 2013; Wang and Kobsa, 2009). The factors that may discourage their boundary-crossing behaviors also emerge from the literature and include employees' privacy concerns (Frampton and Child, 2013; Ollier-Malaterre et al., 2013; Peluchette et al., 2013), pursuit of a balance between work and life (Bucher et al., 2013; van Zoonen and Rice, 2017; van Zoonen et al., 2017), and notably, stress from impression management that may induce identity conflicts (Ollier-Malaterre et al., 2013; Peluchette et al., 2013; van Prooijen et al., 2018).

2.3. Multiple identities, cognitive dissonance theory, and identity conflicts in the workplace

Multiple identities are “meanings that individuals attach to themselves as a function of their multiple social group memberships [...] and roles” (Creary et al., 2015, p. 539). In the workplace, employees may simultaneously possess multiple identities that are either enhancing or conflicting (Ramarajan et al., 2017). These identities could be characterized at different levels by their personal, relational, or group traits, for example, demographic characteristics, family roles, profession, employee–customer relationships, and membership of different social and organizational groups. All of these are salient subjective claims and self-definitions that guide individuals' thoughts and beliefs and profoundly shape employees' behaviors in organizations (Ramarajan,

2014).

Discussions on multiple identities in the workplace have evolved in the past decades. An early social psychological approach assumes that a single salient identity overshadows other identities, and multiple identities may alternate as the situational salience shifts (Hornsey, 2008). Many organizational studies have echoed this approach, suggesting that different identities independently influence organizational behaviors (e.g., Anteby and Wrzesniewski, 2014; Chattopahyay and George, 2001; Johnson et al., 2006). This has prompted critics to bring up the issue of not scrutinizing the co-existence of different salient identities. Therefore, another stream of research has emerged to examine multiple identities that simultaneously stand out. Empirical results have illustrated that different salient identities can be overlapping and eventually converge (Sluss et al., 2012) or conflict with each other and induce a discordant splitting. Intra-unit identity conflicts (or intrapersonal conflicts) in this circumstance refer to “conflicts in the values, beliefs, norms, and expectations held by a single individual” (Horton et al., 2014, p. 8). This concept conveys dissonance in one's sense of self and differs from inter-unit conflicts that involve incompatibilities between values and beliefs of members of different social identity groups.

The cognitive dissonance theory (Festinger, 1957) provides theoretical underpinnings to understand the roots of intra-unit identity conflicts (Horton et al., 2014). In particular, in the current research context, it helps unveil how identity conflicts are generated in employees' cross-boundary impression management. The co-existence of multiple salient identities may induce a conflict with individuals' desire for consonance. According to the cognitive dissonance theory, individuals derive cognition from their own and other people's attitudes and behaviors; however, dissonance will arise if two cognitions are inconsistent. Cognitive dissonance theorists postulate that it is one's inherent desire to pursue harmony and congruity and that distress may be provoked otherwise (Cooper, 2011). When it comes to dissonance between two identities, such a desire may lead to a motivation for uncertainty reduction by reinforcing the central role of a social identity, driving a self-categorization process (Hogg and Terry, 2000).

In particular, intra-unit identity conflicts may arise in the workplace when the degree of tension escalates among multiple identities of the same person and evokes the question “Who am I?” (Horton et al., 2014). In this sense, employees' different identities are intra-psychically interwoven and possibly interfere with each other, which arouses dissonance. In organizational research, individuals may encounter a contradiction between their professional identities and certain social identities such as gender (Cadsby et al., 2013; Karelaia and Guillén, 2014), religious identity (Héliot et al., 2020), sexual identity (Creed et al., 2010), and relational identities (Pillemer and Rothbard, 2018). Due to the incongruity of norms, beliefs, and expectations between different identities, dissonance is sometimes inevitable. Intrapersonal conflicts are not uncommon in the contemporary work environment, given that employees increasingly possess work and non-work identities and transition between roles in different domains (Ashforth et al., 2000). The complexity in interpersonal relationships aroused by boundary spanning may further introduce identity problems, which merits further research investigation.

3. Hypothesis development

3.1. The impact of coworker SNS friendship on identity conflict

The cognitive dissonance theory provides theoretical underpinnings to understand what induces an impression management problem of identity conflict in the current research context. The tenets of the cognitive dissonance theory posit that an individual encounters cognitive dissonance and a state of discomfort when there are inconsistencies between their attitudes, beliefs, or behaviors (Festinger, 1957). At the heart of this theory lies the construct of importance (Harmon-Jones and Mills, 1999; Wicklund and Brehm, 1976). As such, the magnitude of

dissonance is largely determined by the relationship between the two dissonant elements; if importance is placed on these elements, the individual will find it particularly difficult to prioritize them as both have a place of truth. Therefore, the magnitude of dissonance increases in the personal value of the differing elements (Metin and Camgoz, 2011; Starzyk et al., 2009).

The above view constitutes the theoretical underpinnings for the relationship between coworkers' SNS friendships and identity conflicts in the workplace. The advancement of communication technology and in particular SNSs has propelled cross-boundary connectivity between employees and their work contacts; new friendships blossom in this environment (Yang, 2020a; Yang and Wong, 2020). The formation and maintenance of friendships largely depend on two key components: mutual self-disclosure and perceived similarity (Pillemer and Rothbard, 2018). Compared with offline interactions, coworker communications on SNSs typically involve a greater magnitude of information exchange in both width and depth (Huang, 2019). A higher level of self-disclosure—through self-representational posts that cover a wide spectrum of life events, hobbies, and beliefs as well as increased proximity—jointly strengthens coworker friendships on SNS platforms by identifying common interests and values through this sharing (Skeels and Grudin, 2009).

However, such cross-boundary friendships may collide with interpersonal relationships defined in a work domain. Employees' professional roles are delineated by imposed, work-related bonds, whereas at the heart of coworker friendships on SNSs lies a focus based on voluntary behaviors and personalism (Sias and Cahill, 1998; Sias et al., 2004). Individuals are expected to build an identity by demonstrating professionalism, decisiveness, integrity, and fairness in the workplace (Sias et al., 2004; Yan et al., 2021). Intimacy at work may invite unfavorable false accusations of favoritism and workplace deviance behaviors (Karatepe, 2013; Zhuang et al., 2020). By contrast, a friend identity is built in an informal manner through information sharing that is, in many cases, different from the professional norms. Ties established in cyberspace are typically imprinted with agreeableness, trust, proximity, and intimacy (Skeels and Grudin, 2009; Yang, 2020a). Therefore, work identities may differ by a large margin from identities presented on SNSs. According to the cognitive dissonance theory, these inconsistencies give rise to cognitive dissonance (Festinger, 1957) and evoke intra-unit identity conflicts (Horton et al., 2014; Horton and de Araujo Wanderley, 2018). Deepened friendships on SNSs increase the magnitude of dissonance, and escalated conflicts will ensue. Given the above rationale, we propose the first hypothesis:

H1. SNS friendship with coworkers is positively related to identity conflict.

3.2. The impact of identity conflict on workplace outcomes

Drawing on the conservation of resource theory (COR, Hobfoll, 1989), this research develops a framework to explore the negative spillover of identity conflicts induced by boundary-spanning behaviors. The COR is one of the most widely adopted models in organizational research to delineate the causes and consequences of stressful incidents. Resources are referred to as either centrally valued entities such as self-esteem or health or those that serve as a means of acquiring centrally valued ends such as money and social capital (Hobfoll, 2002). Retaining social and psychological resources helps enhance employees' well-being at work, while resource depletion can induce stress and strain (Hobfoll and Shirom, 2000).

Professional identities have been seen as salient workplace resources that enhance employees' affective commitment, creativeness, and resilience under pressure (Caza and Wilson, 2009; Cha and Roberts, 2019). Strong work-role identities are also positively associated with employees' motivation and work performance (Ramarajan et al., 2017). However, dissonance within employees' identity structures inevitably

creates pressure that depletes such resources, leading to behavioral changes and impeding job innovativeness and efficiency (Chen et al., 2021). Identity conflicts will also consume psychological resources when employees make an effort to adapt their identities, which further induces pressure and hinders job performance and satisfaction (Schweisfurth and Raasch, 2020; Veldman et al., 2017). Therefore, the following hypotheses are proposed:

H2a. Identity conflict between work and SNS identities is negatively related to work performance.

H2b. Identity conflict between work and SNS identities is negatively related to job satisfaction.

The above theoretical underpinnings have laid the foundation for the link between cross-boundary coworker friendships and negative job-related outcomes through identity conflicts. As boundary management becomes a prevalent issue for employees when they increasingly connect to colleagues on SNSs, friendships built in cyberspace may bring about negative consequences in the workplace (Skeels and Grudin, 2009; van Zoonen et al., 2016). Such a result could be attributed to the difficulty of managing online and offline identities that conflict with each other, implying a mediation effect of identity conflict. Previous literature has empirically evidenced that identity conflict plays a full mediating effect between the strength of identities and life/work consequences, for example, life satisfaction, psychological well-being, and thriving at work (Gibson et al., 2021; Karellaia and Guillén, 2014; Ward et al., 2018). In the current context, blurring of boundaries between on-work and off-work roles is a hazard to self-presentation and the maintenance of appropriate work images, which subsequently causes problems in meeting the expectations of colleagues in the workplace, in turn inducing undesirable work-related outcomes (Peluchette et al., 2012; van Zoonen et al., 2016; Yang, 2020a). Therefore, the mediating effect of identity conflict is proposed:

H3a. Identity conflict between work and SNS identities negatively mediates the relationship between SNS friendship and work performance.

H3b. Identity conflict between work and SNS identities negatively mediates the relationship between SNS friendship and job satisfaction.

3.3. Task interdependence as moderator

In addition to individuals' personal preferences in managing different domains, contextual workplace factors also condition boundary spanning and boundary management (Kreiner, 2006; Rothbard et al., 2005). Task environment is a key contextual factor that influences individuals' behaviors in organizations (Scott, 2001). Of particular importance to task environment is the concept of task interdependence, defined as the degree to which employees need to interact and collaborate with other team members to complete daily tasks (Liden et al., 2006; Sharma and Yetton, 2003). A high-interdependence working environment centers on communication, information exchange, and teamwork. By contrast, employees in a low task interdependence climate are valued based on individual achievements, while their intra-team collaboration is not as important (Aubé and Rousseau, 2005).

Task interdependence is one of the most intensively researched moderators in previous literature on group dynamics (Anand et al., 2018; Ceri-Booms et al., 2017; Wong and Berntzen, 2019). In the context of cross-boundary friendship, a recent study has provided empirical evidence that task interdependence will strengthen the impact of coworker SNS friendship on instrumental coworker support (Yang and Wong, 2020). Nevertheless, job interdependence may also play a salient contingent role in negative SNS-workplace spillovers. Jobs characterized by high dependence are typically composed of highly interconnected sub-units and require the same resources to complete the sub-units (Kiggundu, 1983). Therefore, professional knowledge and

job-related support from other team members are essential for the execution of one's own task in such a climate. This particularly accentuates the importance of professional identities. As the magnitude of dissonance increases in the importance attached to the conflicting elements (Metin and Camgoz, 2011; Starzyk et al., 2009) for employees in a high-interdependence working environment, SNS friendships will induce a higher magnitude of dissonance and thus more identity conflict. This gives rise to the last hypothesis:

H4. Task interdependence strengthens the relationship between SNS friendships and identity conflict, such that at a high level of task interdependence, the positive relationship between SNS friendship and identity conflict is stronger.

Fig. 1 depicts the conceptual model of the current paper.

4. Methodology

4.1. Data collection

Data were collected from six 5-star hotels in Macao SAR, China. Renowned as the gaming capital of the world, Macao has seen rapid development of its hotel industry in the past two decades. In addition, Facebook has been one of the most widely adopted SNS platforms in Macao that connect hotel employees and their colleagues (Yang, 2020a). Given the research purpose of this study, Macao is considered an appropriate city for data collection. To rule out possible influences of hotel types, only employees of five-star hotels were surveyed. In 2019, the five-star hotels had 39,061 employees, representing 76% of all the hotel employees in Macao (The Statistics and Census Service (DSEC), 2019). Prior to the survey, permissions were sought from top management. The respondents were hotel employees and their supervisors working in different functional teams. The selection criteria (Hackman, 2002) suggested that each team possesses a common goal, a team leader to oversee the daily process, and a stable membership (only full-time employees with at least six months of team tenure were surveyed).

The survey administrator first introduced the objective of the study and ensured that the survey was conducted voluntarily, anonymously, and confidentially. Each respondent was given a survey package

containing a self-administered questionnaire and an envelope with a pre-assigned identification number. Two versions of the questionnaire were distributed to the hotel employees and their supervisors, respectively. Identified through a screening question, qualified hotel employees were those who had befriended team members on Facebook. They were asked to assess their friendships with team members on Facebook, perceived identity conflict, task interdependence, and job satisfaction. The supervisors provided the work performance scores for each team member.

The survey packages were initially distributed to 423 employees and their supervisors in 50 teams. The completed questionnaires were returned sealed after four weeks and consisted of responses from 43 supervisors and 392 employees. The responses of those who did not pass the screening question were excluded for two reasons: (a) because they were in teams with fewer than three team members' responses and (b) because they were supervisor-subordinate dyads without an evaluation of work performance. Finally, the survey collected valid responses from 319 hotel employees in 42 teams. The number of team members ranged from 4 to 19, and the average team size was 7.60. Such a sample size is sufficient for robust and accurate estimations in a multilevel design, according to the rule of thumb of (Meuleman and Billiet, 2009), which specifies 20 groups in Level 2 as a suggested minimum and 40 groups as a sufficient size.

Most of the team members were female (58%) and had a bachelor's degree (82%). About half of them were aged between 26 and 35 years (52%). The majority reported that they were single (74%). Regarding the departments in which the respondents worked, a total of 12% worked in the front office, 6% in housekeeping, 15% in the sales and marketing department, 32% in the area of F&B/banquet, and 30% in the back office. On average, their organizational tenure was 2.12 years. As for the supervisors, 62% of them were female, 48% were above 35 years old, and 95% had a bachelor's degree.

4.2. Measures

Items used in the survey, originally designed in English, were translated into Chinese following a back-to-back approach to ensure face and construct validity. To ensure that the items could be correctly

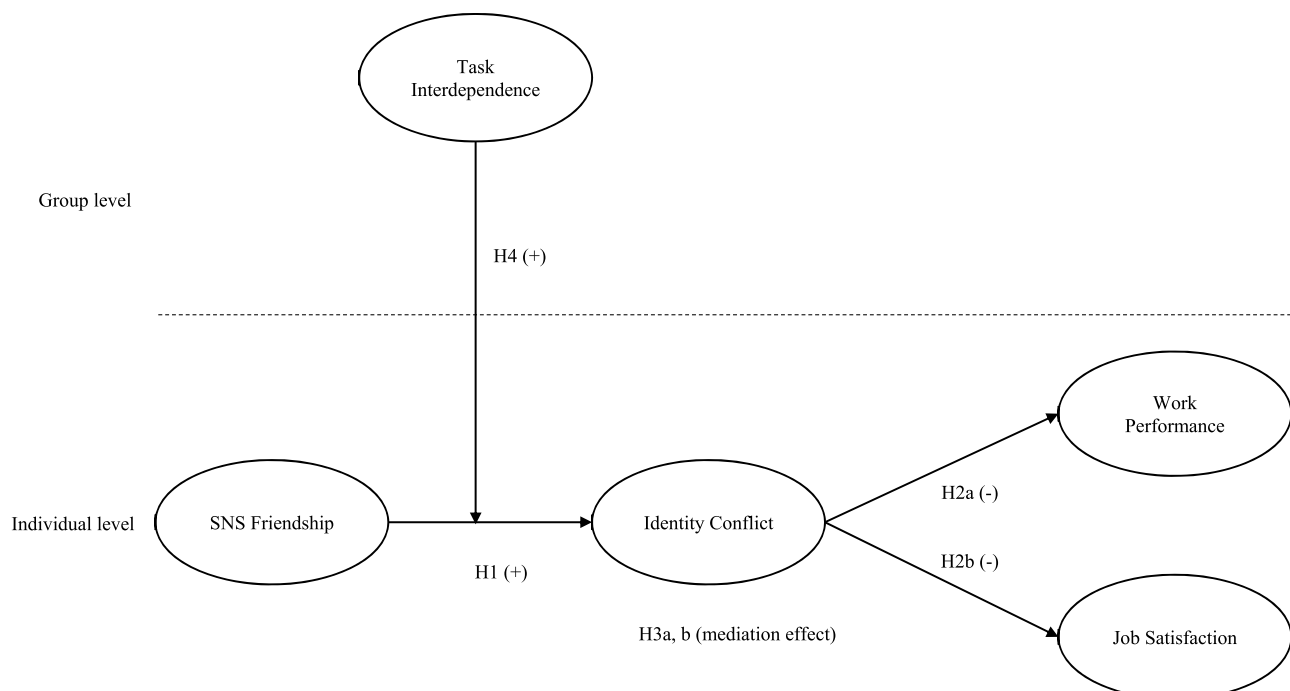


Fig. 1. The conceptual model.

interpreted, a pilot test was administered to 30 employees and their supervisors. The main survey was conducted afterwards. The measurement items are presented in the Appendix.

4.2.1. SNS friendship

Six items were adopted from the workplace friendship scale in Nielsen et al. (2000), with modification to fit with the context of Facebook. The scale had adequate scale consistency with $\alpha = .87$.

4.2.2. Identity conflict

A six-item scale was adopted from Settles (2004) to measure employees' perceived identity conflict. The items were slightly modified to fit the context of this research. The scale had adequate scale consistency with $\alpha = .86$.

4.2.3. Work performance

To assess work performance, the respondents were asked to rate four items adopted from Williams and Anderson (1991). The scale was highly reliable with $\alpha = .93$.

4.2.4. Job satisfaction

Employees' job satisfaction was evaluated by three items adopted from Cammann et al. (1983). The scale had adequate scale consistency with $\alpha = .83$.

4.2.5. Task interdependence

A three-item scale was modified from Campion et al. (1993). The scale had adequate scale consistency with $\alpha = .87$.

Each item was assessed using a seven-point anchor ranging from 1 (strongly disagree) to 7 (strongly agree).

4.2.6. Control variables

We controlled for gender and organizational tenure on all the individual-level endogenous variables to exclude their influence on work-related outcomes (Hon, 2013).

Multilevel analysis is a common practice for research designs with a nested structure (Hofmann and Gavin, 1998). The homogeneous nature of jobs in the same group may lead to similar responses regarding task interdependence. Such a nested structure is found in previous literature on cross-boundary friendships (Yang and Wong, 2020). Therefore, multilevel analysis is considered appropriate for the current research. The measurement models were tested by Mplus 8.3, and the cross-level hypothesized relationships were tested by Hierarchical Linear Modeling (HLM) 7.0.

5. Findings

5.1. Preliminary analysis

Means, standard deviations, and inter-correlations are presented in Table 1. The findings demonstrate significant correlations between SNS friendship and (1) identity conflict ($r = .33, p < .001$), (2) work performance ($r = .18, p < .01$), and (3) job satisfaction ($r = .13, p < .05$). The results also indicate significant correlations between identity conflict and work performance ($r = -.17, p < .01$) and between identity conflict and job satisfaction ($r = -.21, p < .001$). Thus, preliminary support has been provided for the individual-level hypotheses.

5.2. Aggregation tests

Task interdependence is considered a group-level factor in previous research (Aubé and Rousseau, 2005; Liden et al., 2006) and is thus aggregated on a team level. The study compared the intra-class correlation (ICC) and within-group agreement (r_{wg}) values with the suggested criteria (Bliese, 1998). The ICC(1), ICC(2), and average r_{wg} estimate were .30, .75, and .88, respectively, comfortably exceeding the suggested criteria (.12, .70, and .70, respectively). The results have justified the aggregation of task interdependence.

5.3. Measurement model

The measurement model fit was first determined through a confirmatory factor analysis (CFA) test at the individual level. A five-factor model (full-measurement) indicates adequate fit indices ($\chi^2/df = 2.63$, CFI = .94, NNFI = .93, RMSEA = .07, SRMR = .06). In the second model, items in the two factors with the highest correlation—identity conflict and task interdependence—were combined. This four-factor model had a worse fit ($\chi^2/df = 5.07$, CFI = .86, NNFI = .82, RMSEA = .11, SRMR = .11). Finally, all the items were loaded on a single factor, and this model yielded a poor fit ($\chi^2/df = 16.48$, CFI = .42, NNFI = .32, RMSEA = .22, SRMR = .21). The results reinforced the good fit of the full-measurement model and supported discriminant validity at the individual level.

A multilevel CFA was further conducted given the multilevel structure (Dyer et al., 2005). As shown in Table 2, the five-factor model had adequate fit indices ($\chi^2/df = 2.78$, CFI = .94, NNFI = .93, RMSEA = .07, SRMR_{within} = .04, SRMR_{between} = .03). The second model combined items in SNS friendship and identity conflict—the two factors with the highest correlation at the individual-level—which fit worse than the five-factor model ($\chi^2/df = 8.27$, CFI = .75, NNFI = .70, RMSEA = .15, SRMR_{within} = .17, SRMR_{between} = .03). Finally, all the individual-level items were loaded on a single factor, and this model yielded a poor fit ($\chi^2/df = 25.23$, CFI = .43, NNFI = .37, RMSEA = .23, SRMR_{within} = .24, SRMR_{between} = .03). The results reinforced the good

Table 1
Descriptive statistics and inter-correlations.

	M	Std	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
<i>Individual-level variables</i>									
1. Gender	1.58	0.49	—						
2. Organizational tenure	2.12	1.50	.10	—					
3. SNS friendship	3.75	1.20	-.10	-.22***	—				
4. Identity conflict	2.84	1.19	-.25***	-.03	.33***	—			
5. Work performance	5.26	1.02	.16**	-.02	.18**	-.17**	—		
6. Job satisfaction	4.89	1.05	-.05	.08	.13*	-.21***	.32***	—	
<i>Group-level variable</i>									
7. Task interdependence	3.71	0.99	-.16**	-.02	.26***	.39***	.22***	.02	—

Note:

* $p < 0.05$;

** $p < 0.01$;

*** $p < 0.001$.

Table 2
Scale items and validation.

Scale items	Standardized loadings	α	CR	AVE
Individual-level variables				
<i>SNS friendship</i>		.87	.93	.70
On Facebook, I have formed strong friendships with my team members.	.79			
On Facebook, I socialize with my team members.	.80			
On Facebook, I can confide in my team members.	.92			
On Facebook, I feel I can trust many team members a great deal.	.91			
Being able to see my team members is one reason why I look forward to using Facebook.	.83			
I do not feel that any team member I work with is a true friend on Facebook. (R)	.76			
<i>Identity conflict</i>		.86	.95	.74
I feel that other team members don't take me seriously at work because I am their friend on Facebook.	.90			
Being their team member makes me difficult to be my coworkers' Facebook friend.	.82			
I think I am not influential enough at work because I am my team members' friend on Facebook.	.86			
I run into obstacles in role as a colleague because I am my team members' friend on Facebook.	.94			
I feel uncomfortable being their friend on Facebook when I am with a group of my team members.	.90			
Being a team member does not conflict with my identity of being a friend on Facebook. (R)	.74			
<i>Work performance</i>		.93	.94	.78
Adequately completes assigned duties.	.83			
Fulfills responsibilities specified in job description.	.95			
Performs tasks that are expected of him/her.	.85			
Meets formal performance requirements of the job.	.90			
<i>Job satisfaction</i>		.83	.88	.71
All in all, I am satisfied with my job.	.94			
In general, I don't like my job. (R)	.73			
In general, I like working here.	.84			
Group-level variable				
<i>Task interdependence</i>		.87	.89	.73
I cannot accomplish my tasks without information or materials from other members of my team.	.90			
Other members of my team depend on me for information or materials needed to perform their tasks.	.85			
In my team, jobs performed by members are related to one another.	.81			

Note: $\chi^2/df = 2.78$, CFI = .94, NNFI = .93, RMSEA = .07, SRMR_{within} = .04, SRMR_{between} = .03

α = Cronbach's α , CR = composite reliability, AVE = average variance extracted

fit of the five-factor model and supported discriminant validity. For the five-factor model, the standardized loadings ranged from .73 to .95, all significant at the .001 level. All the composite reliability (CR) values were comfortably higher than the .70 threshold ($CR \geq .88$), and the average variance extracted (AVE) values were greater than the suggested minimum of .50 ($AVE \geq .70$). In addition, the Cronbach's α values all exceeded .70. Therefore, the reliability and internal consistency of the constructs were assured.

5.4. HLM results for main and mediating effects

The main and mediating effects are summarized in Table 3. SNS friendship will positively influence identity conflict ($\beta = .22, p < .001$). The result supports H1 and implies that being close with coworkers in cyberspace will induce identity conflicts. In addition, such a conflict will further influence employees' work performance ($\beta = -.20, p < .001$) as well as job satisfaction ($\beta = -.32, p < .001$). Therefore, H2a and H2b find empirical support. When the effect of identity conflict has been added, SNS friendship still plays a significant positive role in work performance ($\beta = .22, p < .001$) and job satisfaction ($\beta = .22, p < .05$).

The mediating effect of identity conflict was tested through the Monte Carlo simulation procedure with 20,000 replications. As for the indirect effects through identity conflict, the indirect effect of SNS friendship on work performance is -0.04 (95% CI = $[-0.08, -0.02]$), and the indirect effect of befriending coworkers in cyberspace on job satisfaction is -0.07 (95% CI = $[-0.12, -0.04]$). Therefore, both H3a and H3b find empirical support for the partial mediation effects of identity conflict, indicating that identity conflict negatively mediates the relationship between SNS friendship and work performance/satisfaction.

5.5. Results for moderating effects

Table 4 summarizes the cross-level results. Task interdependence strengthens the relationship between coworker SNS friendship and identity conflict ($\gamma = .24, p < .01$), supporting H4. Fig. 2 further presents the effects of SNS friendship on identity conflict with different levels of task interdependence.

Finally, the study estimated the indirect relationship between SNS friendship and work performance/job satisfaction via identity conflict at three levels of task interdependence, specifically low level (-1 SD), medium level (mean), and high level ($+1$ SD). For work performance, the negative indirect effect becomes stronger in high task interdependence. The estimate was reported as 0.01 at the low level of task interdependence (95% CI = $[-0.03, 0.05]$), -0.04 at the medium level (95% CI = $[-0.07, -0.02]$), and -0.09 at the high level (95% CI = $[-0.15, -0.04]$). A moderated mediation effect is also yielded for job satisfaction. The indirect effect through task interdependence was 0.01 for the low level of task interdependence (95% CI = $[-0.05, 0.07]$), -0.07 at the medium level (95% CI = $[-0.12, -0.04]$), and -0.14 at the high level (95% CI = $[-0.23, -0.08]$). The results indicate that the competitive mediation effect of identity conflict becomes stronger when the level of intra-team interdependence increases.

Table 3
Results of main and mediating effects.

Predictors	Identity conflict		Work performance		Job satisfaction	
	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE
Intercept	2.82***	0.11	5.27***	0.08	4.89***	0.06
<i>Individual level (Level 1)</i>						
Gender	-0.18	0.11	0.24**	0.09	-0.13	0.12
Organizational tenure	0.06	0.03	0.09***	0.03	0.06*	0.02
SNS friendship	0.22***	0.05	0.22***	0.05	0.22*	0.09
Identity conflict			-0.20***	0.05	-0.32***	0.06
Deviance	958.83		882.90		882.86	
Pseudo R ²	0.06		0.13		0.34	

Note:

Coefficients are unstandardized.

N = 319 for Level 1 variables, N = 42 for the Level 2 variable.

* $p < 0.05$;

** $p < 0.01$;

*** $p < 0.001$.

Table 4
Results of moderating effects.

Predictors	Identity conflict		Work performance		Job satisfaction	
	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE
Intercept	2.81***	0.10	5.26***	0.07	4.89***	0.06
<i>Individual level (Level 1)</i>						
Gender	-0.22*	0.11	0.22*	0.09	-0.13	0.12
Organizational tenure	0.06	0.03	0.09***	0.03	0.06*	0.02
SNS friendship	0.21***	0.04	0.21***	0.05	0.22*	0.09
Identity conflict			-0.20***	0.05	-0.32***	0.06
<i>Group level (Level 2)</i>						
Task interdependence (TI)	0.41*	0.20	0.35**	0.11	0.05	0.07
<i>Level 1 × Level 2 interaction</i>						
SNS friendship × TI	0.24**	0.08				
Deviance	953.40		874.58		883.65	
Pseudo R ²	0.07		0.15		0.35	

Note:

Coefficients are unstandardized.

N = 319 for Level 1 variables, N = 42 for the Level 2 variable.

* $p < 0.05$;

** $p < 0.01$;

*** $p < 0.001$.

6. Conclusion and discussion

6.1. Conclusion

With SNSs soaring in popularity and blurring work–life domains, it is worth noting the paradigm shifts of interpersonal relationships among work colleagues. This study investigates negative work-related consequences through a multilevel study. Befriending coworkers on SNSs has provoked new issues of identity conflict across different domains, which consequently undermine work performance and satisfaction; such identity dissonance only holds for individuals in a task environment of high interdependence. This paper is the first empirical study of image management problems in relation to employees' boundary-crossing behaviors. The contributions to academia and the hospitality industry are discussed below.

6.2. Theoretical implications

6.2.1. The self-presentation crisis in cross-boundary relationships

While the positive workplace outcomes of boundary-crossing friendships have been discussed (e.g., Huang, 2019; Huang and Liu, 2017; Yang, 2020a; Yang and Wong, 2020), empirical evidence for negative spillovers is scarce. Image discrepancies and image management have long been an issue in organizational studies when employees need to transition between different roles (Ladge and Little, 2019). A conflict may arise when there is dissonance between social norms in the workplace—for instance how employees should perform in their job role—and an understanding of how other colleagues expect them to perform in an SNS context. Such an identity conflict may provoke an image management or self-presentation crisis that merits more research attention. Previous studies have tapped into the impression presentation issue in an exploratory manner, and calls have been issued to empirically investigate the cyberspace–workplace interface from the perspective of impression management.

The findings of this study have provided solid evidence that identity conflict is a problem in cross-boundary relationships between work colleagues. While SNS friendships and professionalism are not exactly like water and oil that cannot mix, they are more or less in conflict with each other and provoke an identity dissonance issue. This result echoes the exploratory findings in previous research that has raised the issue of self-presentation (e.g., Ollier-Malaterre et al., 2013; Peluchette et al., 2012, 2013; Yang, 2020a). Self-presentation theorists posit that individuals are actors whose daily performances are staged to manage impressions of a variety of audience groups (Goffman, 1959). Different self-presentation tactics exist, referred to as being on-stage when interactions occur in a professional context and being backstage when self-imposed restrictions are lifted and employees can be themselves (Peluchette et al., 2013). However, the segmentation of professional and personal identities may be more difficult when boundary-spanning technology has enabled seamless transitions between work and online domains with more frequent, in-depth interactions.

Moreover, such an incongruity could be toxic and undermine performance and job satisfaction (Wong et al., 2019). In a recent study, Yang and Wong (2020) have documented a positive spillover on job embeddedness and satisfaction through coworker support. This paper responds to their call for studies to examine the “too close to work together” myth and provides empirical evidence of a negative mechanism between SNS friendship and workplace outcomes—identity conflict. The result also echoes the findings of Yang (2020a) that both fun and stress exist side by side with blended work and SNS friend roles, affording much food for thought regarding the consequences and

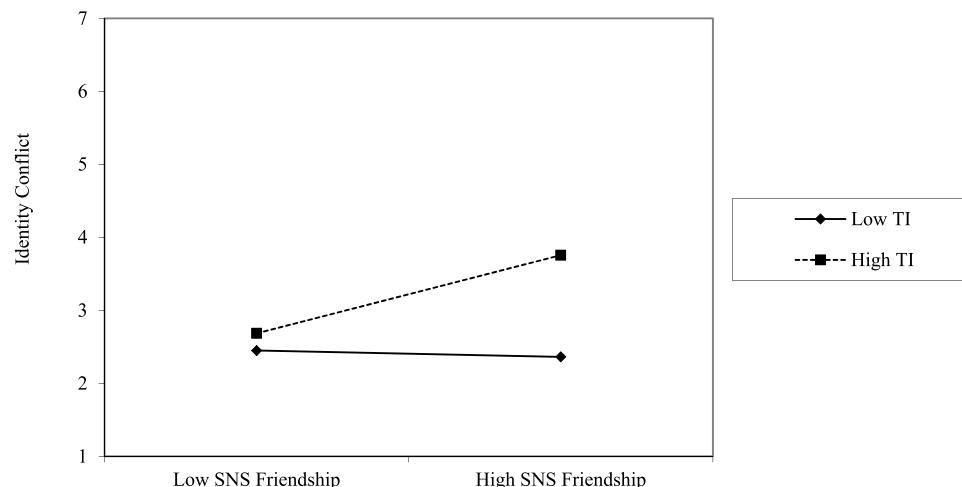


Fig. 2. Moderating effect on the relationship between SNS friendship and identity conflict. Note: TI = Task Interdependence.

channels of boundary-spanning relationships.

6.2.2. Management of multiple identities in a new arena

This study contributes to research on multiple identities that calls for more studies to explore the configuration of a blend of virtual and real identities (Ramarajan, 2014). Studies on the management of multiple identities remain scarce in organizational research, while shifting trends in globalization, diversity, and technology are reshaping the workplace, “making multiple identities increasingly salient for people” (Ramarajan, 2014, p. 591). While previous studies have predominantly concentrated on identity conflicts in the real world (e.g., Cadsby et al., 2013; Hélot et al., 2020; Karelaia and Guillén, 2014; Pillemer and Rothbard, 2018), this research has extended the research context to a hybrid arena of the workplace and the virtual world and has pioneered a new direction for multiple identity research.

This study also adds new insights to the cognitive dissonance theory—one of the most influential theories that shape the discipline of social psychology (Harmon-Jones and Mills, 1999). As noted by (Hinojosa et al., 2017), management research differs from contrived, laboratory experiments and has the advantage of explaining the cognitive dissonance process. The current study has extended the boundary conditions of the cognitive dissonance theory to a novel hybrid context across work and life domains. It also advances the implications of the theory to team-level dynamics, responding to the call by Hinojosa et al. (2017) for the cognitive dissonance theory to be examined beyond the individual level and providing new evidence about how different levels of dissonance are generated among groups.

6.2.3. Task interdependence as a double-edged sword

This research makes significant contributions to the literature on institutional contingencies. Interestingly, intra-team communication and collaboration intensify the negative cyberspace–workplace spillovers via dissonant identities, as the competitive mediation effect of identity conflict becomes stronger in the level of task interdependence. Task interdependence is predominantly resorted to as a positive moderator in group studies, for instance to strengthen the tie between person-focused leadership and team performance (Anand et al., 2018; Hon and Chan, 2013), to attenuate the negative impact of knowledge hiding (Duan et al., 2019; Fong et al., 2018), and to reinforce the influence of SNS friendships on reciprocal support in the workplace (Yang and Wong, 2020). The result of the current study, however, has unraveled the potentially dark side of task interdependence as an intensifier of negative cyberspace–workplace spillovers. This finding is also in line with empirical evidence that task interdependence can strengthen the interpersonal stressor-strain nexus in organizations (Dadaboyev et al., 2019; Welbourne and Sariol, 2017). As a working environment with high task interdependence requires reliance on coworkers, it is difficult to avoid frequent within-team interactions, and thus disharmony among colleagues, if it exists, will be exaggerated. The findings have identified new avenues for research to study task interdependence as a double-edged sword in organizations.

6.2.4. Identity management in the era of COVID-19

In particular, the COVID-19 pandemic has added more complexity to the management of cross-boundary identities. On one hand, employees are increasingly adopting SNSs as a source of information, a platform to keep connected with others during the adversity, and an outlet to vent frustrations about working conditions and life issues amid COVID-19 (Park et al., 2020). With the social-distancing policies and work-from-home arrangements in effect, more employees resort to SNSs to communicate with their colleagues for both work- and leisure-related purposes. This has imposed greater challenges to set boundaries between work and life images and thus, has threatened identity negotiation in the era of COVID-19 (Oksanen et al., 2021). On the other hand, the pandemic has taken a toll on employee psychology and social issues, increasing exclusion, loneliness, unemployment, and discrimination (Ou

et al., 2021; Wong et al., 2021). Negative sentiment of SNS posts after the outbreak of COVID-19 may induce risks for image management; tension in the air is also likely to escalate when debates about the pandemic arise on SNSs (Cinelli et al., 2020; Park et al., 2020). More dissonance is thus evoked between a professional identity and personal identity. Therefore, cross-boundary identity management becomes a more pertinent issue for employees in the pandemic, and the current study can add a new dimension to research on human resource management in COVID-19.

6.3. Managerial implications

The results have paved the way for employees and hotels to be better prepared for identity conflicts in cross-boundary relationships. As SNS friendships also nurture fun, trust, and reciprocal behaviors in the workplace (Yang, 2020a; Yang and Wong, 2020), it may not be optimal for employees to shy away from befriending their work colleagues on SNS platforms. However, they still need to acknowledge that identity conflicts largely reside in such boundary-spanning relationships. Appropriate management of social-work boundaries and self-presentation may rely on different tactics, which can be based on either employees' self-disclosure or hotel policies and proper human resource management.

Strategies based on self-disclosure may help employees tailor the seeds on SNSs, for instance to segment topic domains and define content conforming to expectations of difference audiences in each domain. If no such segmentation strategy is adopted, employees may also err on the side of caution with respect to their posts on SNSs and avoid content that may shape an inappropriate image. However, there are possible issues with these disclosure-based tactics. Holding back on SNSs and concealing information from work colleagues may demotivate beneficial extra-role behaviors (Yang, 2020b). Therefore, hotel employees should balance the tradeoffs when adopting such tactics. For example, sharing ordinary leisure activities such as attending a concert or gathering of friends should be fine. However, employees may need to think twice before posting private, unconventional, controversial, or socially undesirable topics on SNSs where coworkers are active, as such posts may create a conflicting image between personal and professional identities. In the era of COVID-19, they should also be cautious when posting contentious issues about the pandemic. In new staff training and career workshops, hotels should keep their employees well informed about potential identity conflicts due to cross-boundary friendships and remind them of possible consequences of these conflicts if they intend to blend elements on SNSs and in the workplace.

Tactics based on policies urge employees to keep in mind that SNS friendships should not override professional etiquette and organizational rules. To avoid undesirable work performance induced by identity conflicts, hotels should clearly define their standard operating procedures, assessment criteria, and reward/punishment policies; job descriptions should be clear enough to back decision-making while avoiding negative impacts caused by cross-boundary relationships with coworkers. Hotels should also strive to underline the importance of these policies and stress the importance of maintaining professionalism via training (Lan et al., 2021). In this way, hotel employees could strictly follow the work guidelines and rules while also availing themselves of the benefits of SNS friendships in a culture rooted in fun, support, and camaraderie. Such a policy-based tactic could address inconvenience in the workplace provoked by the intimacy of SNS friendships, for example, preferential treatment, hiding of disagreement, and ignorance of organizational procedures. This is particularly imperative for teams with high task interdependence such as those in the front office. As frontline employees work closely as teams to serve hotel guests, it is more likely that their SNS friendships could cause identity conflicts, according to the study findings. Therefore, management needs to be more aware of the potential conflicts and to strive to lower the negative impacts on job performance. The job responsibilities of each front office

position should be specified in detail and task allocations should be based on the job design, so that each employee will know exactly what he or she is expected to do rather than expecting intimate coworkers to cover the jobs.

From the managerial perspective, hotels can organize more team-building activities to cultivate coworker relationships in an offline setting in order to reduce online–offline identity conflicts, in particular for teams with high task interdependence. These activities or games would help employees to know more about each other outside the work environment; coworkers' self-representation would also become multifaceted, which would decrease the perceptual inconsistency between their virtual image and their real image, reducing cognitive dissonance in identity. Team-building activities can also improve job satisfaction (Amos et al., 2005) and employee competence (Potnuru et al., 2019), offsetting the negative outcomes of identity conflicts associated with SNS friendships.

6.4. Limitations and future research

Our study is not without its limitations, which suggest directions for future research. First, like most of the previous studies, the current research has assessed SNS interactions with team members as a whole. Future studies could enrich the body of research by scrutinizing dyadic relationships and provide more insights on impression management with different audiences. Nuances between work- and non-work-related SNS interactions and their impacts on identity conflict can also be investigated. Second, although the multi-source approach and one-factor test have both addressed potential common method bias, future studies could take a longitudinal approach to further remedy the risks. A time-varying model could also advance our understanding of the conflict changes in different stages. Third, as power-laden relationships between leaders and members differ vastly from coworker relationships (Yang, 2020b), the current research only examines identity conflict induced by coworker friendships on SNSs. Job hierarchy and supervisor–subordinate dynamics could be an area for future study. Fourth, this study is the first attempt to empirically investigate self-presentation issues in cross-boundary relationships. Future studies could further investigate other contextual factors, for example, hotel types, cultural backgrounds, voice climates, and leadership styles, as potential moderators that condition the generation of SNS-induced identity conflicts. In addition, consonant identities across different domains and how they can facilitate workplace relationships are another area that we leave for future endeavors.

Data availability

Data will be made available on request.

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Appendix. Measurement items

SNS friendship (Source: Nielsen et al., 2000).

1. On Facebook, I have formed strong friendships with my team members.
2. On Facebook, I socialize with my team members.
3. On Facebook, I can confide in my team members.
4. On Facebook, I feel I can trust many team members a great deal.
5. Being able to see my team members is one reason why I look forward to using Facebook.

6. I do not feel that any team member I work with is a true friend on Facebook.

Identity conflict (Source: Settles, 2004).

1. I feel that other team members don't take me seriously at work because I am their friend on Facebook.
2. Being their team member makes me difficult to be my coworkers' Facebook friend.
3. I think I am not influential enough at work because I am my team members' friend on Facebook.
4. I run into obstacles in role as a colleague because I am my team members' friend on Facebook.
5. I feel uncomfortable being their friend on Facebook when I am with a group of my team members.
6. Being a team member does not conflict with my identity of being a friend on Facebook.

Work performance (Source: Williams and Anderson, 1991).

The employee can.

1. Adequately completes assigned duties.
2. Fulfills responsibilities specified in job description.
3. Performs tasks that are expected of him/her.
4. Meets formal performance requirements of the job.

Job satisfaction (Source: Cammann et al., 1983).

1. All in all, I am satisfied with my job.
2. In general, I don't like my job.
3. In general, I like working here.

Task interdependence (Source: Campion et al., 1993).

1. I cannot accomplish my tasks without information or materials from other members of my team.
2. Other members of my team depend on me for information or materials needed to perform their tasks.
3. In my team, jobs performed by members are related to one another.

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